

- (b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (c) Rajendra Prasad
- (d) Sachchidananda Sinha

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (c)

The Constituent Assembly was not sovereign at the time of formation; it was declared sovereign on 15th August, 1947 AD and that day Rajendra Prasad was elected as permanent President of Constituent Assembly. So Rajendra Prasad is the correct answer.

8. Which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) The Constituent Assembly of India was elected by the Provincial Assemblies in the year 1946.
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru, M.A. Jinnah and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel were members of the Constituent Assembly of India.
- (c) The first session of the Constituent Assembly of India was held in January, 1947.
- (d) The Constitution of India was adopted on 26th January, 1950.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Under the Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946, elections were held for the first time for Constituent Assembly. The elections for the 296 seats assigned to the British Indian provinces were completed by July, 1946 AD. Congress won 208 seats and Muslim League won 73 seats and other independent candidates won 15 seats. M.A. Jinnah was not a member of the Constituent Assembly of India. The Constituent Assembly was the first Parliament of Independent India. Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha was the first President (Temporary Chairman of the Assembly) of the Constituent Assembly when it met on December 9, 1946 AD. Dr. Rajendra Prasad then became the permanent President of the Constituent Assembly, and later became the first President of India. The Constitution of India was adopted on 26th November, 1949 AD.

9. Which political party's National Executive called for the dissolution of the Constituent Assembly and its re-election by adult suffrage?

- (a) Hindu Mahasabha (b) Socialist Party
- (c) Swaraj Party (d) Muslim League
- (e) Question not attempted

Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

The National Executive of the Indian Socialist Party in 1946 A.D. demanded the dissolution of the Constituent Assembly and its re-election through universal adult suffrage. Socialist leaders such as Jayaprakash Narayan and Ram Manohar

Lohia argued that the Constituent Assembly, which was indirectly elected by the Provincial Legislatures, did not adequately represent the common Indian people. Therefore, these leaders advocated for a more democratic process and called for the reconstitution of the Constituent Assembly based on universal adult suffrage.

10. Sachchidananda Sinha was associated with :

- (a) Quit India Movement
- (b) Dandi March
- (c) Civil Disobedience Movement
- (d) None of these

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Sachchidananda Sinha was associated with Quit India Movement. He was elected as temporary President in the first meeting of the Constituent Assembly (9 December, 1946 AD).

11. Who among the following held the Office of Speaker in Central Legislative Assembly of British era and the Parliament of free India?

- (a) Sir Abdur Rahim
- (b) G.V. Mavlankar
- (c) Ananat Shayanam Ayanger
- (d) Vitthal Bhai Patel

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

G. V. Mavlankar held the office of Speaker of Central Legislative Assembly of British era (24 January 1946 AD to 14 Aug, 1947 AD) and was speaker of Lok Sabha after Independence from 1952 AD to 1956 AD. He was President of Legislative Assembly of Bombay province from 1937 AD to 1946 AD.

Formation of Interim Government (1946)

*On **12th August, 1946 AD** Lord Wavell invited Congress President Jawahar Lal Nehru to form the Interim Government. On 24th August, 1946 AD under the leadership of Jawaharlal Nehru, Congress announced first Interim Government of India. On **2nd September, 1946 AD** First Interim Government of India was formed in which Muslim League didn't participate in the beginning.

***Dr. Rajendra Prasad** was the Minister of Agriculture and Food in the Interim Government. **Baldev Singh** was Defence Minister. **Foreign and Commonwealth Affairs** were looked by Jawahar Lal Nehru in this interim government. **Asaf Ali** held Rail and Transport Ministry in the interim government of 1946 AD. *Muslim League after repeated requests by Lord Wavell joined the Interim Government in 1946 AD. In October, 1946

AD five members of League joined the Interim Government. ***Liaquat Ali** was given Finance Ministry, who in his Budget presentation imposed several taxes on businessmen and industrialists. ***Abul Kalam Azad** was not a member of this Interim Government. ***This Interim Government had twelve congress Ministers-** Jawahar Lal Nehru, Sardar Vallabh Bhai Patel, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, Asaf Ali, C. Rajagopalachari, Sharat Chandra Bose, Dr. John Mathai, Sardar Baldev Singh, Sir Safat Ahmed Khan, Jagjivan Ram, Syed Ali Zaheer and C.H. Bhabha. Three of these twelve were to be removed when Muslim League joined the Interim Government, they were - **Syed Ali Zaheer, Sharat Chandra Bose and Sir Safat Ahmed.** ***Krishak Praza Party** in the leadership of **A.K. Fazlul Haq** joined hands with Muslim League and this coalition won the election in Bengal and Cabinet of the Muslim League was formed in Bengal which ruled till 14th August 1947 AD. *** H.S. Suhrawardy** was its Prime Minister. ***16th August, 1946 AD** was decided as Direct Action day by Muslim League. Muslim League demanded independent and sovereign Pakistan State after its members resigned from Interim Government. On the Direct Action Day rioting activities were prevalent. It was shown through violence that Hindu and Muslim couldn't live together in one country. **'Noakhali'** was the main centre of these activities.

1. **Who headed the Interim Cabinet formed in the year 1946?**

- (a) Rajendra Prasad
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
- (d) Rajagopalachari

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

After accepting the last offer proposed by Viceroy, Lord Wavell formally invited Congress president Jawaharlal Nehru to form a Government. The first Indian Interim Government under the leadership of Nehru was announced on 24th August, 1946 AD and officiated on 2nd September 1946 AD in which Muslim League did not participate.

2. **In the leadership of Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru interim Government formed in –**

- (a) July, 1946
- (b) August, 1946
- (c) September, 1946
- (d) October, 1946

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. **When was an interim government formed under Jawaharlal Nehru?**

- (a) July, 1946
- (b) August, 1946
- (c) September, 1946
- (d) October, 1946

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. **Who was given the princely portfolio in the National Provisional Government?**

- (a) V.P. Menon
- (b) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
- (c) Krishna Shahi
- (d) C. Rajgopalachari

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2021

Ans. (b)

Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel was given the princely portfolio, home affairs, Information and Broadcasting in the National Provisional Government.

5. **Home department was established under whose presidency?**

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi
- (b) J.L. Nehru
- (c) J.B. Pant
- (d) Sardar Patel
- (e) None of the above/ more than of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. **Which Portfolio was held by Dr. Rajendra Prasad in the Interim Government formed in the year 1946?**

- (a) Defence
- (b) External Affairs and Commonwealth Relations
- (c) Food and Agriculture
- (d) None of the above

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Food and Agriculture Portfolio was held by Dr. Rajendra Prasad in the Interim Government formed in the year 1946 AD. In this Government, the portfolio of defence ministry was held by Baldev Singh and the department related to Commonwealth Relations and External Affairs was headed by Jawaharlal Nehru.

7. **In the Interim Government (1946) who held the Railways Portfolio?**

- (a) Baldev Singh
- (b) T. T. Chundrigar
- (c) Asaf Ali
- (d) Abdul Rab Nishtar

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

In the Interim Cabinet of 1946, Railways and Transport Portfolio was headed by Asaf Ali.

8. **When the Indian Muslim League was inducted into the Interim Government in 1946, Liaquat Ali Khan was assigned the Portfolio of –**

- (a) Foreign Affairs
- (b) Home
- (c) Finance
- (d) Defence

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

A series of meetings took place between Jinnah and Lord Wavell and ultimately Muslim League joined the Interim Government in October, 1946 AD. Liaquat Ali Khan was appointed as Finance Minister who imposed high duties on traders and people in business in his budget.

9. Who was the Finance Minister in the Interim Government?

- (a) Liaquat Ali Khan (b) Sardar Patel
- (c) M.A. Jinnah (d) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Who among the following was the Finance Minister in Nehru's interim Government in 1946?

- (a) Fazlul Haq
- (b) Khizr Hayat Khan
- (c) Liyaqat Ali Khan
- (d) Ghaznafar Ali Khan

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Who was allotted the Portfolio of the Labour Department in the Interim Government's Cabinet of 1946 AD?

- (a) Jagjivan Ram
- (b) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- (c) Dr. Anugraha Narayan Singh
- (d) Syed Ali Zaheer
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (a)

In the interim Government formed in 1946 AD, the labour department was given to Babu Jagjivan Ram, Rajendra Prasad was given the Department of food and Agriculture. Joginder Nath Mandal was given the department of law.

12. Who among of the following was not a member of Interim Cabinet?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (b) Baldev Singh
- (c) Ali Zaher
- (d) B. R. Ambedkar

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

The Interim Government of India was formed on 2nd September, 1946 AD from the newly elected Constituent Assembly as per the Cabinet Mission Plan which was declared on 24th August, 1946 AD. After inclusion of League in the Interim Government, Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel, Rajendra Prasad, Ibrahim Ismail Chundrigar, C. Rajagopalachari, Baldev Singh, Liaquat Ali Khan, Ghazanfar Ali Khan, Jagjivan Ram, Abdur Rab Nishtar, Asaf Ali and C.H. Bhabha were included. Some members like Sarat Chandra Bose, Sir Shafat Ahmed Khan and Syed Ali Zaheer appointed earlier resigned to make room for the Muslim League nominees Who joined constituent Assembly on 26 October, 1946 AD. B.R. Ambedkar was not included in Interim Cabinet.

13. Who among the following was not minister in interim Government formed on 2nd September, 1946?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (b) Liyaqat Ali Khan
- (c) Abul Kalam Azad
- (d) Dr. Rajendra Prasad

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b & c)

See the explanation of the above question.

14. In which province Muslim League formed their Government after 1946 elections?

- (a) Bengal (b) North-East province
- (c) Punjab (d) Bihar

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Muslim League formed Government in Bengal under A.K. Fazlul Haq with an alliance of Krishak Praja Party in the elections of 1946 AD but later the ministerial cabinet of the Muslim League was formed. The leader of the Muslim League in Bengal and Prime Minister of the province was H.S. Suhrawardy.

15. Muslim League observed the 'Direct Action Day' on :

- (a) 13 August, 1946 (b) 14 August, 1946
- (c) 15 August, 1946 (d) 16 August, 1946

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

16th August, 1946 was the date which was decided by Muslim League as the 'Direct Action Day.' Muslim League demanded separate Pakistan by rejecting the interim cabinet decision of Viceroy. On that day, by spreading riots, they wanted to show that Hindus and Muslims can not exist together. During the action, 'Nowakhali' was the center of riots.